lacked performance, and posed maintenance challenges. However, my affinity for streamlined architecture never wavered, remaining a guiding light in my quest for efficient and effective solutions.

My journey into the world of Elasticsearch began in 2015, around the same time big data became mainstream. I was working on Enterprise Java Beans (EJBs), using application server beasts like JBoss and WebLogic that favored monolith architectures, and I was instantly drawn to Elasticsearch's simplified architecture—especially its programming-language-agnostic support, out-of-the-box functionality, performance, and excellent documentation. It took me a couple of years to embrace Elasticsearch's full potential and adopt it in its entirety.

Despite Elasticsearch's simplicity and robust capabilities, I realized that the learning curve was steep, and its intricate internal mechanisms warranted guided navigation through the myriad features and inherent challenges. Understanding the countless features and labyrinth of documentation required hand-holding. This realization led me to approach Andy Waldron at Manning.

Creating a book is an endeavor that often requires late nights, sacrificed weekends, and holidays spent at the writing desk. It's a colossal task that could never see fruition without the unwavering support of family. And in this case, it was a two-year journey marked by relentless focus and determination to bring this book into your hands.

While I am typically reserved about my achievements, I can't help but acknowledge the hard work that went into this particular project. It deserves a self-issued pat on the back. Over the course of these two years, not a single day was clouded by self-doubt, and that's a feat worth celebrating.

Now, as you read *Elasticsearch in Action, Second Edition* I feel a profound sense of gratitude and delight. I appreciate your purchase and am excited for you to embark on this journey into the world of Elasticsearch.

As big data and cloud computing have grown with unprecedented momentum over the last decade, so have the depth and breadth of Elasticsearch's capabilities. Its relevance has continued to expand, reflecting the evolving demands and opportunities of these dynamic technological landscapes. Its advanced features, including multi-language analyzers, geospatial and time-series storage, anomaly detection using machine learning algorithms, graph analytics, auto-complete and fuzzy searching, root cause analysis using log stores, rich visualizations of data, complex aggregations, and many more, make Elasticsearch a must-have tool for most organizations and businesses.

I sincerely hope you enjoy reading this book as much as I've enjoyed writing it!